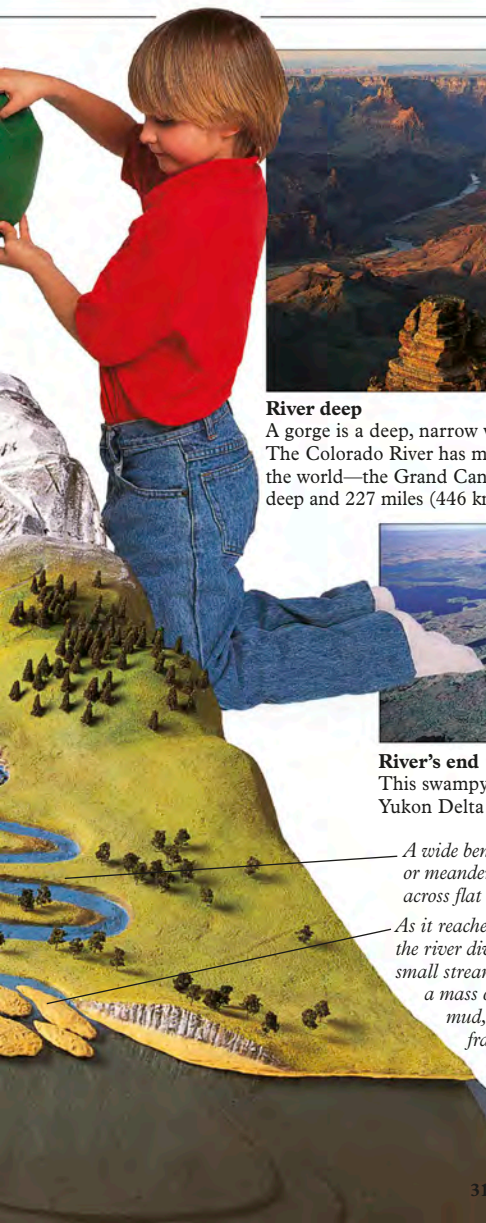
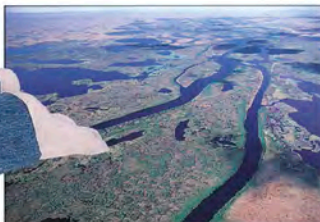




River deep

A gorge is a deep, narrow valley carved by a river. The Colorado River has made the largest gorge in the world—the Grand Canyon. It is 1 mile (1.6 km) deep and 227 miles (446 km) long.



River's end

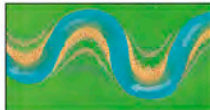
This swampy land is part of the Yukon Delta in Alaska.

A wide bend or meander goes across flat country.

As it reaches the sea, the river divides into small streams, leaving a mass of sand, mud, and rock fragments, called a delta.

Round the bend

When a river reaches flat land, it slows down and begins to flow in large loops. It leaves behind sand, gravel, and mud, called deposits. This changes the river's shape and course.



The river leaves deposits on the inside bend and eats away the outer bend.



The deposits change the shape of the bend. In time, the neck of the bend narrows and the ends of the neck join up.



The river leaves behind a loop. It is called an oxbow lake because of its shape.

Record rivers

The Nile, in Africa, is the longest river in the world. It is 4,130 miles (6,650 km) long. The largest delta covers 40,500 square miles (105,000 sq km). It is made by the Ganges and Brahmaputra rivers, in Bangladesh and India.

